

PROSPER AWUNI

Security Engineer | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR) | Microsoft Sentinel | Detection Engineering | Cloud Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Security Engineer specialising in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) platforms. I have over five years of hands-on experience in detection engineering, security automation, and cloud security across complex enterprise environments. My core expertise spans Microsoft Sentinel (including Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection authoring and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), CrowdStrike Falcon Extended Detection and Response (EDR/XDR), and PowerShell-based security automation. I have a strong background in cloud security telemetry across Microsoft Azure, and I am experienced in designing and operationalising detection-as-code approaches to improve detection coverage and consistency. I am seeking a permanent remote role where I can apply my SIEM/XDR engineering expertise to build and mature detection capabilities at scale within a technology-forward organisation.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, analytics rules, workbooks, data connectors), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), alert triage and detection lifecycle management
- **Extended Detection and Response (XDR) / Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender, CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover)
- **Detection Engineering and Automation:** Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection authoring, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection coverage mapping, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development, Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps automation
- **Cloud Security and Telemetry:** Microsoft Azure security logging, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD / Entra ID) audit and sign-in telemetry, Conditional Access, cloud workload protection
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting for security operations, incident response automation, and security tool integration
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Compliance Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Lead the SIEM/XDR engineering function at UAL, owning the full lifecycle of Microsoft Sentinel detections across an 8,000-user estate, from requirements and authoring through to testing, deployment, and continuous tuning.
- Design, develop, and maintain detection-as-code analytics rules in Kusto Query Language (KQL), covering endpoint, identity, cloud, and email threat vectors, aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework to ensure comprehensive and structured coverage.
- Engineer and optimise Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks within Microsoft Sentinel using Logic Apps, automating triage, enrichment, and response actions for high-frequency alert categories to reduce analyst mean time to respond (MTTR).

- Configure and maintain the Extended Detection and Response (XDR) platform, including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and the Microsoft 365 Defender suite, ensuring alerts are accurately tuned and correlated across the full XDR telemetry surface.
- Manage Azure cloud security logging and telemetry, ensuring comprehensive data ingestion from Azure Active Directory (Azure AD / Entra ID), Conditional Access, Azure Monitor, and workload event sources into Microsoft Sentinel.
- Administer the CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) platform, managing custom Indicators of Attack (IoA), prevention policies, and real-time response capabilities.
- Develop PowerShell scripts to automate security operations workflows, including alert enrichment, incident creation, and evidence collection, integrating across Microsoft APIs and third-party security tools.
- Lead incident response engagements aligned to NIST SP 800-61, applying XDR telemetry and SIEM correlation to investigate and contain threats rapidly.
- Manage the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), feeding vulnerability intelligence into detection engineering priorities.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Built and maintained KQL-based analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel, including scheduled, near real-time (NRT), and machine learning-based anomaly detection rules, improving detection coverage across endpoint, identity, and email threat surfaces.
- Developed SOAR automation playbooks for automated alert response, phishing triage, and endpoint isolation, reducing manual analyst workload and standardising incident handling procedures.
- Managed Microsoft Sentinel data connectors, onboarding new log sources including Mimecast, CrowdStrike Falcon, Azure AD, and Intune, ensuring consistent telemetry coverage across all key security data sources.
- Administered the Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI) platforms, tuning detection policies, managing alert queues, and performing real-time endpoint response actions.
- Managed the CrowdStrike Falcon EDR platform, including event stream analysis, custom detection logic, and real-time response for endpoint-based threats.
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts for identity lifecycle management, security tool integration, and routine security operations tasks, improving operational efficiency.
- Leveraged Azure cloud logging and identity telemetry for threat hunting and anomaly investigation, covering Azure AD sign-in events, Conditional Access audit logs, and cloud resource activity.
- Authored internal security run-books and detection engineering documentation, standardising the team's approach to rule authoring, testing, and tuning within Microsoft Sentinel.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Delivered security engineering for a cloud-native SaaS FinTech organisation, configuring Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), endpoint security tooling, and cloud security logging to establish security telemetry and visibility.
- Managed Azure AD identity security controls including MFA, Conditional Access, and audit log monitoring, applying security automation to streamline identity governance workflows.
- Supported incident investigation activities by analysing endpoint and identity telemetry, applying structured triage and root cause analysis methodologies.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance activities, including audit preparation, control gap analysis, and policy documentation.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and maintained a MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection library of KQL analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel, achieving structured coverage across over 30 ATT&CK techniques across endpoint, identity, and cloud threat categories.
- Engineered a Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation framework within Microsoft Sentinel that automated end-to-end responses for the top five high-volume alert categories, significantly reducing analyst workload.

- Improved mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) by deploying correlated XDR detections across Microsoft Defender and CrowdStrike Falcon, enabling earlier threat identification and faster containment.
- Expanded Microsoft Sentinel telemetry coverage by onboarding multiple new data connectors including Mimecast, Entra ID, CrowdStrike, and Intune, eliminating critical detection blind spots.
- Developed PowerShell-driven security automation pipelines that integrated Microsoft Sentinel with downstream response tools, enabling consistent and repeatable incident response at scale.
- Led multiple complex incident response investigations using XDR telemetry and SIEM correlation, resulting in full containment of threats and executive-level post-incident reporting.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (UK)